Northwest UNIVERSITY

SCHOOL OF BUSINESS ACCREDITATION PORTAL USER MANUAL

Your workspace, explained.

A practical guide for staff and administrators

Keep accreditation requirements, evidence and semester reviews together. This guide explains the everyday workflow and how to recover deleted records.

Who can do what?

Staff update existing criteria, checklists and workspace content, upload evidence, and export information.

Administrators also create and delete records, manage owners and account access, and restore archived items or backups.

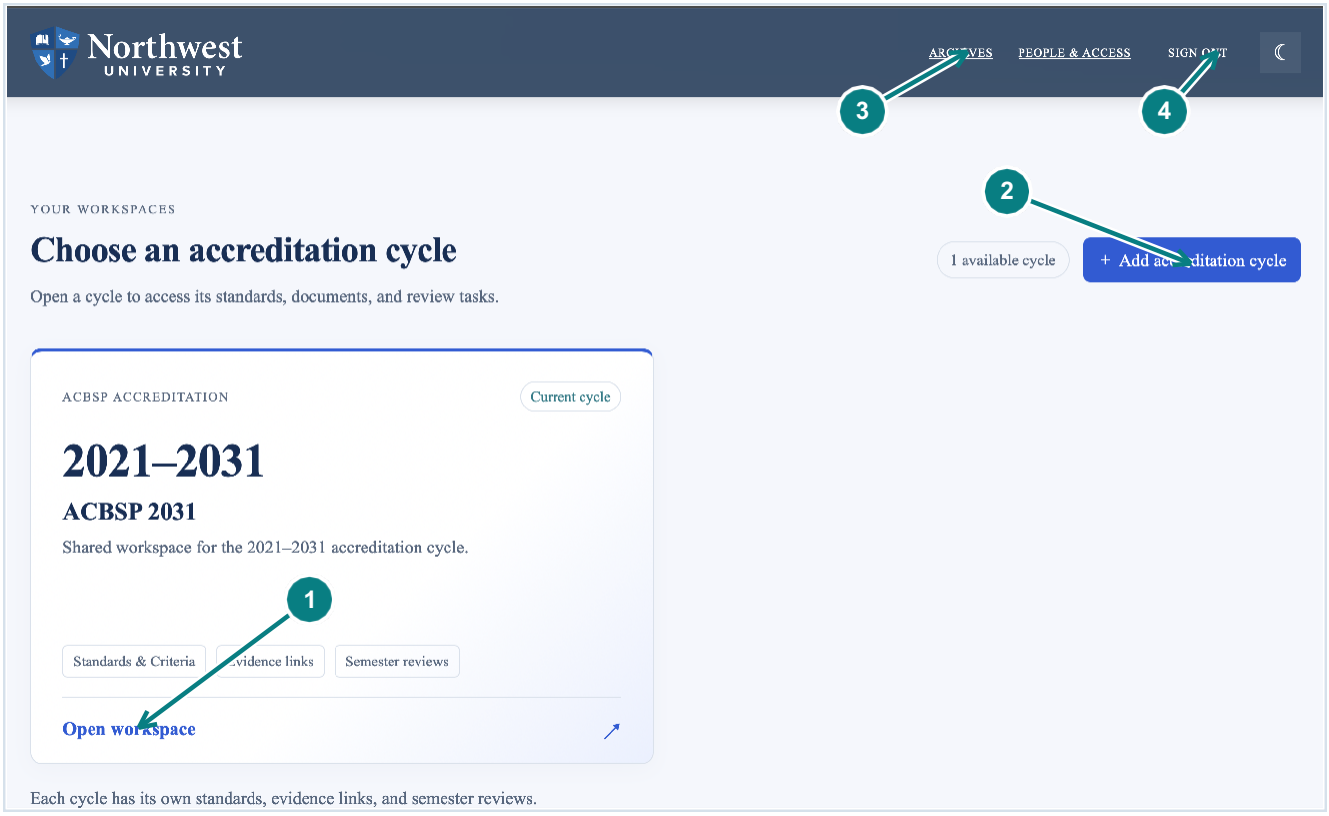
About this edition

This guide describes the current prototype. Screenshots show demonstration content, not verified accreditation progress.

Remember: Your institution must confirm the applicable accreditation requirements. Starter criteria are editable placeholders.

Choose your cycle

The homepage connects your workspaces and account controls.



1. Open workspace – Open the cycle you want to work on. Each cycle keeps its own standards, evidence and reviews.

2. Add accreditation cycle – Administrators can create a new cycle using a starter framework, a copied framework or a blank one.

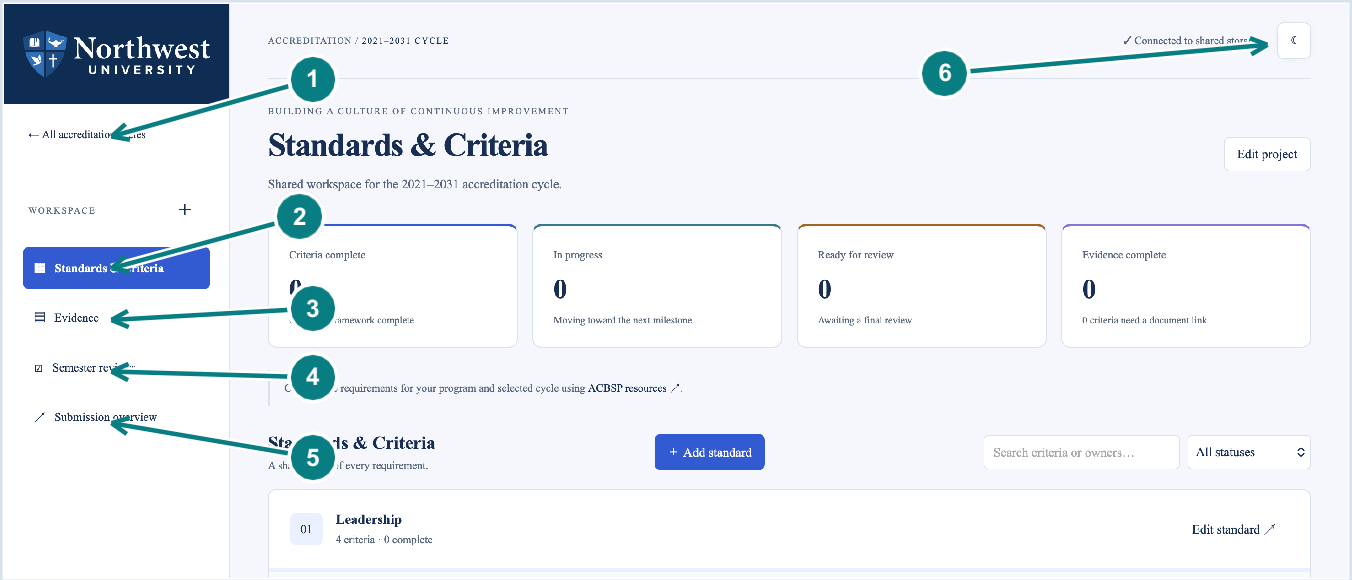
3. Archives and People & access – Administrators restore deleted records and manage account access or criterion owners here.

4. Sign out and theme – Sign out when finished. The moon or sun changes the display theme.

Remember: Confirm the cycle years before editing. Changes belong to the cycle you have opened.

Find your way around

Match each numbered arrow to the explanation below.



1. **All accreditation cycles** – Return to the homepage to open another cycle or reach the administrator links.
2. **Standards & Criteria** – Assign owners and update requirement status, evidence status, notes and document links.
3. **Evidence** – Upload documents and copy their links for use in criteria.
4. **Semester reviews** – Use a checklist for each standard and review period.
5. **Submission overview** – Open the attention list or Progress tracker to review the saved work.
6. **Theme** – Use the moon or sun to switch the display theme.

Remember: The Workspace + control creates custom sections for administrators. Navigation labels can differ if sections have been customized.

Update a requirement

Related controls, explained together



1. Criterion name – Click a criterion to open its edit form. Change its title, notes and links, then choose Save changes.

2. Owner – Choose a person or team. Administrators add names through People & access, not this dropdown.

3. Status – Choose Not Started, In Progress, Ready for Review or Complete.

4. Evidence status – Choose Needed, Partially Collected, Complete or Not needed.

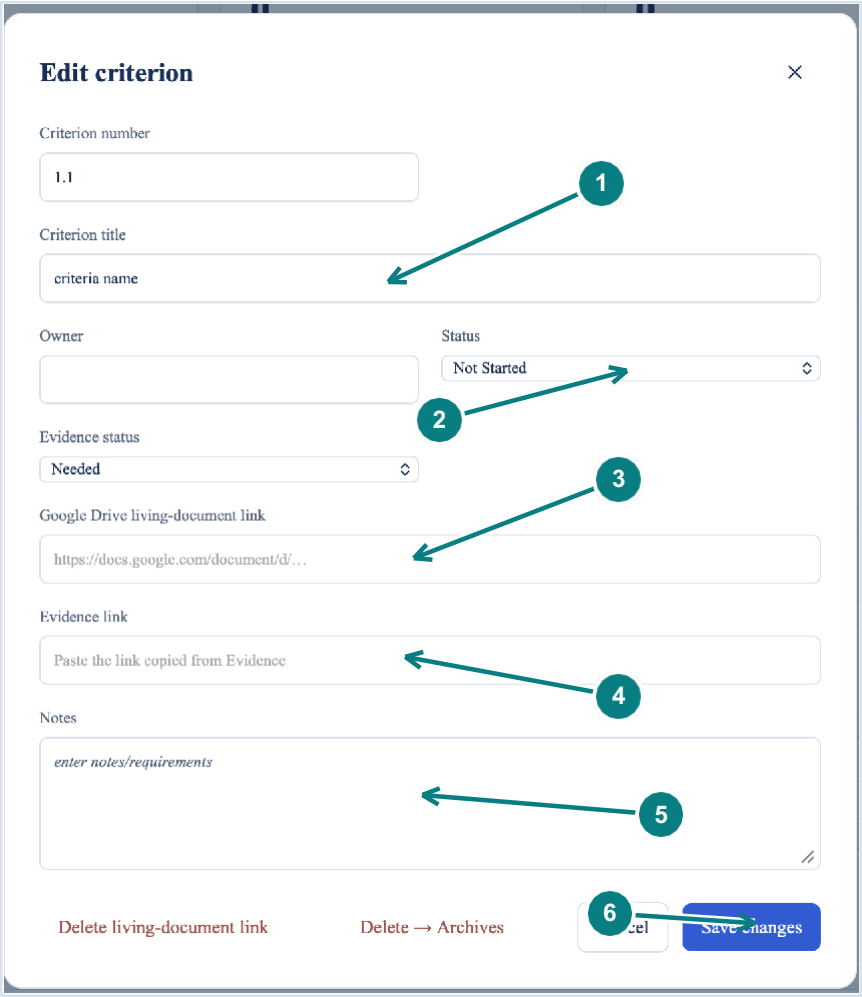
5. Living document – Open Drive opens the linked Google document. Its sharing permissions are managed in Google Drive.

6. Evidence link – Paste a copied evidence link into an empty field. After saving, it appears as Open evidence.

Remember: Dropdown updates save immediately. Administrators can replace or remove existing evidence references. Search and status filters help locate criteria.

Inside the criterion form

Edit the details, then save the complete form.



1. **Number and title** – Use the approved criterion number and a meaningful title.

2. **Owner and statuses** – Assign responsibility and record work and evidence status separately.

3. **Living-document link** – Paste the Google Drive document used for the working narrative.

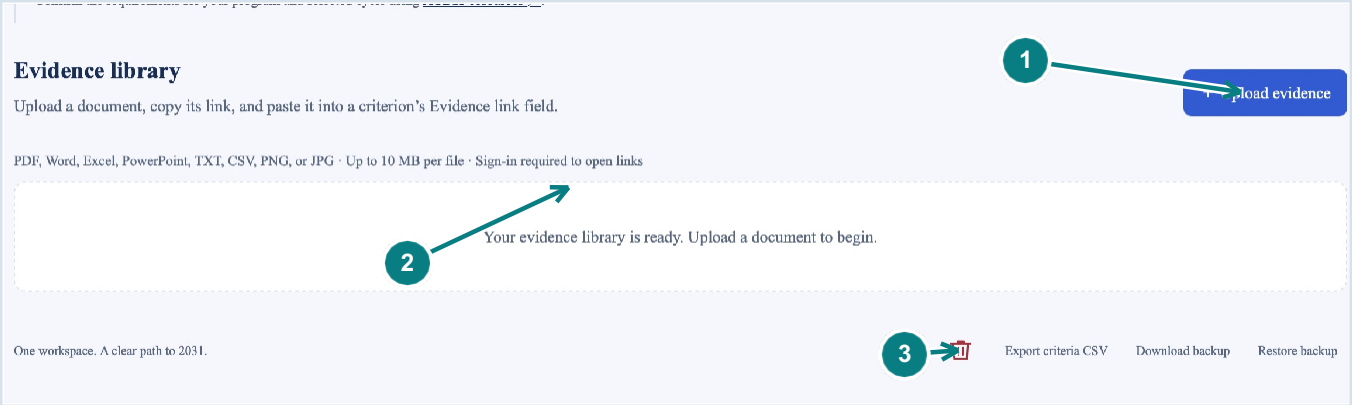
4. **Evidence link** – Paste the link copied from the Evidence library.

5. **Notes** – Record requirements, decisions or follow-up work.

6. **Save changes** – Save before closing. Cancel or the close icon leaves your edits unsaved.

Upload and link evidence

Upload once, then reuse the document link in your criteria.



1. Upload evidence – Choose a file and wait for confirmation. PDF, DOCX, XLSX, PPTX, TXT, CSV, PNG and JPG are supported, up to 10 MB per file.

2. Evidence library – Uploaded documents appear here. On a document card, use Copy link, then paste it into a criterion's Evidence link field. It becomes Open evidence after saving.

3. Cycle trash icon – This footer icon deletes the cycle, not an individual file. To delete one evidence record, use the trash icon on that document's card (administrator only).

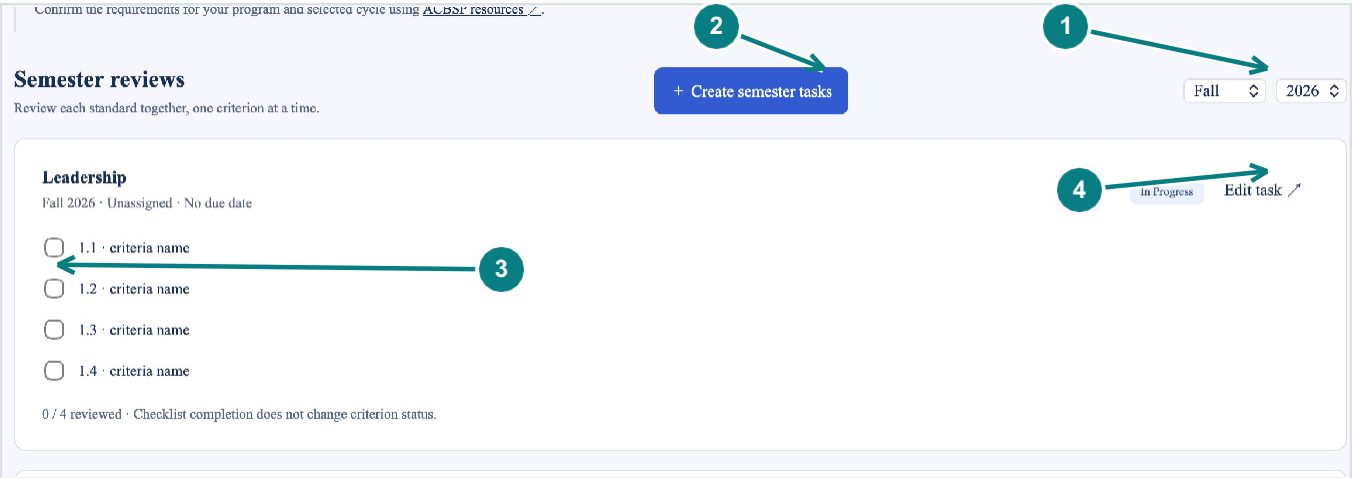
Keep the same link when a document changes

Open the uploaded document, download and edit it, then select **Upload updated version** on its document page. Earlier versions remain available and the link stays the same.

Remember: This screenshot shows an empty library. Portal uploads are stored on the tracker server, not automatically in Google Drive. Portal links require sign-in; localhost links work only on the development computer.

Run a semester review

A review checklist is separate from criterion completion.



1. Semester and year – Choose Spring or Fall and the reporting year.

2. Create semester tasks – An administrator creates a checklist for each standard in that period. Repeating this does not duplicate existing tasks.

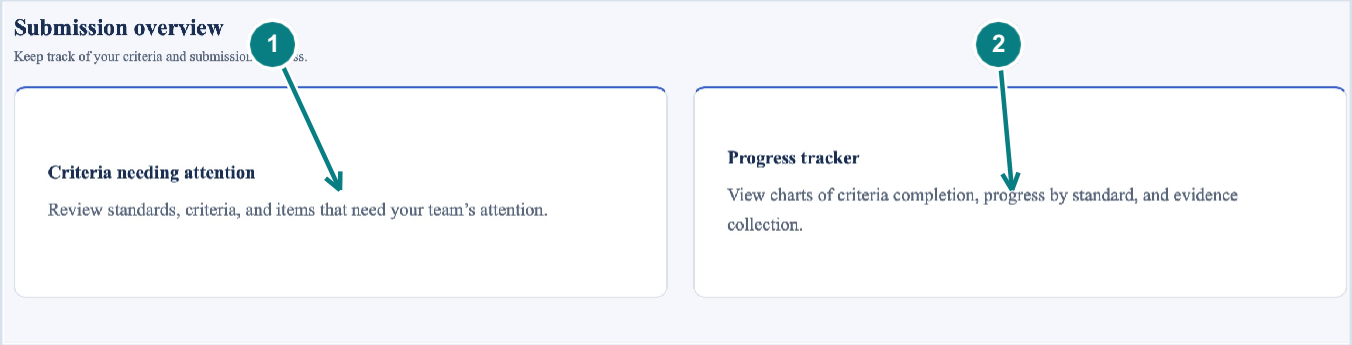
3. Criterion checkboxes – Check each criterion when it has been reviewed. Changes save immediately; this does not change its Standards & Criteria status.

4. Edit task – Set the owner, due date and notes. A checklist is complete when it contains criteria and every item is checked.

Remember: New criteria join the relevant standard's checklist automatically. Review the checklist again after changing the framework.

Open the submission overview

Two focused views keep the overview easy to scan.



1. Criteria needing attention – Open this card for the standards and criteria that need follow-up, including missing owners and incomplete work. Document hyperlinks open the related material.

2. Progress tracker – Open this card for a separate chart view of saved progress. Select an overall view or compare standards.

Use the overview in a team meeting

1. Review the attention list and identify the next actions.

2. Update owners, statuses and evidence links in Standards & Criteria.

3. Return to Progress tracker and refresh to see the latest saved changes.

4. Use Print / Save PDF from the detail view when you need a team summary.

Remember: Readiness indicators describe recorded work. They do not verify evidence quality, document permissions or official accreditation compliance.

Read the progress chart

One screenshot, four controls



1. Overall criteria progress – The headline summarizes all completed criteria in the cycle. This screenshot contains sample statuses.

2. Show – Choose overall progress, percentages per standard, or completed versus total criteria.

3. Chart type – Switch between column, horizontal bar and line views without changing the underlying statuses.

4. View counts and standard names – Expand this section to read the figures behind the chart.

Remember: Three completed criteria out of four means 75%. Charts compare current saved work; the line is not a timeline.

Create a custom workspace

Organize drafts, resources and charts inside a cycle.

1. As an administrator, select + beside Workspace. Enter a clear name, such as Assessment Draft, and choose its category.

2. Choose Text, Document, Media, Pictures, Charts or a custom category. Open the new section from the sidebar.

3. For ordinary sections, add notes and a resource link, then save. Upload supported files through Evidence and reuse their links here.

Build a chart



Chart-builder reference: chart type selection on the left and a live preview on the right.

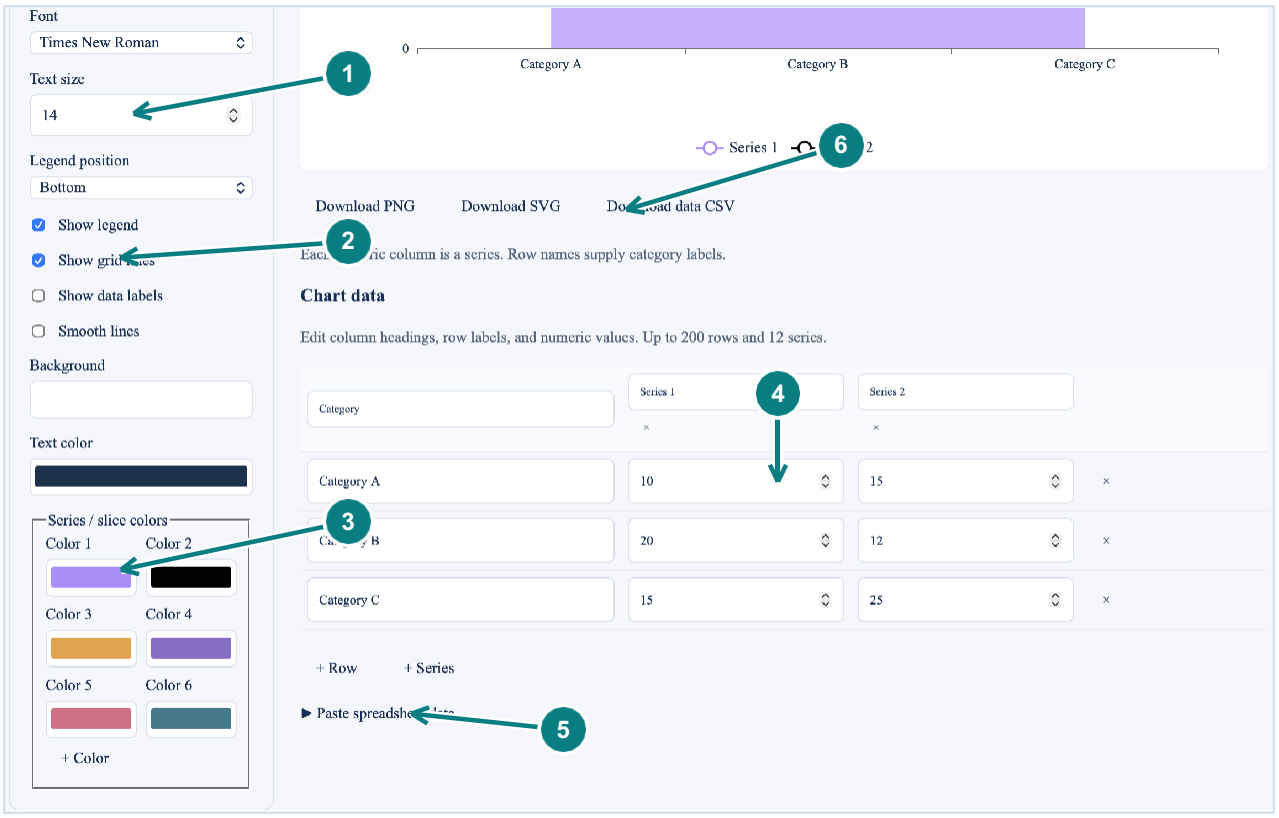
Select a chart type, edit the data table or paste spreadsheet data, and customize titles, colors, fonts, legends and labels. Follow the displayed data-format guidance for specialized chart types.

Choose **Save chart** before navigating away. Export options include PNG, SVG and data CSV. Example values are demonstration data; replace them with your own.

Remember: Administrators can right-click a sidebar section, or focus it and press Shift+F10, to open its menu. There is no three-dot button.

Customize and export a chart

Use the same numbers to find settings and data controls.



1. Font and text size – Set the chart typography. These settings affect the chart, not the whole portal.

2. Legend, grid and labels – Choose the legend position and which supporting elements appear.

3. Colors – Set the chart background, text and series or slice colors.

4. Chart data – Edit category labels, series names and values. Use + Row and + Series to expand the table.

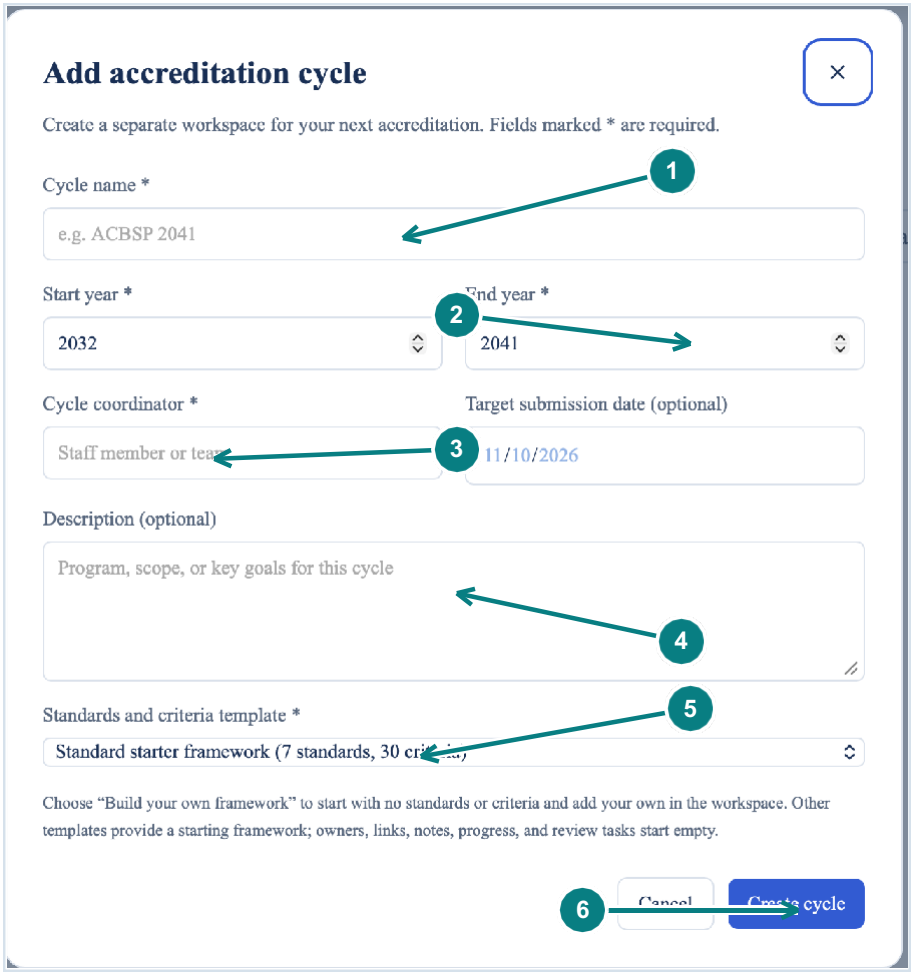
5. Paste spreadsheet data – Open the paste area to bring tabular values into your chart.

6. Downloads – Export a chart as PNG or SVG, or download the chart data as CSV.

Remember: Scroll up and choose Save chart before leaving. Downloading an image does not replace saving your workspace chart.

Create the next cycle

Administrator task | Start a separate workspace



1. Cycle name – Use a recognizable name, such as ACBSP 2041.

2. Years – Enter the start and end years carefully; cycle years are fixed after creation.

3. Coordinator and target date – A coordinator is required. The target submission date is optional.

4. Description – Optionally describe the scope or goals for the cycle.

5. Framework – Use the starter, copy an existing framework, or build your own from empty. Copied frameworks reset owners, progress, links, notes and review tasks.

6. Create cycle – Open the new workspace and customize its standards and criteria.

Manage people and owners

Administrator task | Account access and assignment names are different.



1. University email – Enter the approved Northwest University Microsoft account.

2. Account ID – Use the Microsoft Entra user Object ID supplied by IT, not a teacher or employee number.

3. Role – Staff update existing work; administrators also create, delete, restore and manage people.

4. Save access – Save the access record. This does not create a Microsoft account or send an invitation.

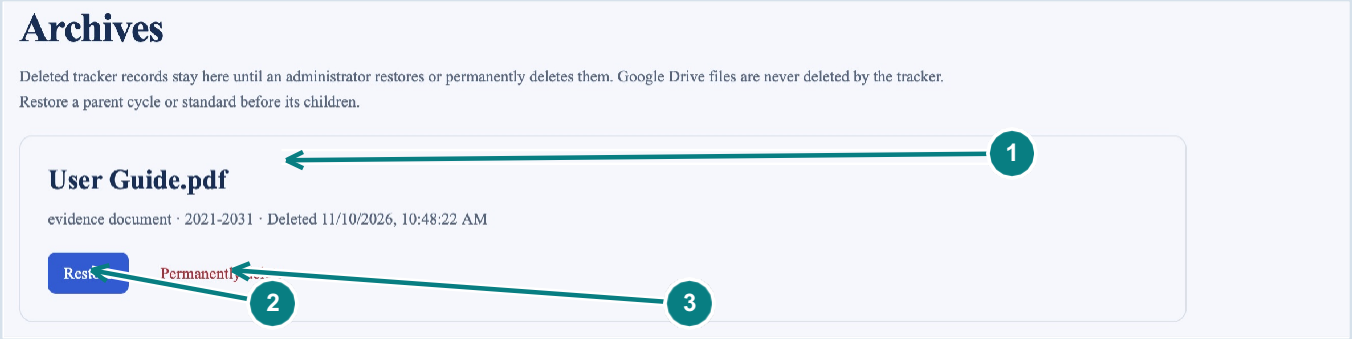
5. Criterion owners: cycle – Choose which cycle should offer the owner in its dropdowns.

6. Owner name and Add owner – Enter a person or team and add it. Refresh the workspace to see the name. This does not grant sign-in access.

Remember: University sign-in requires IT configuration. Local development access is only for building and testing.

Restore from Archives

Administrator task | Recover the record before rebuilding it.



1. Identify the record – Check the name, record type, cycle and deletion time.

2. Restore – Return an accidentally deleted record to the portal. Restore a parent cycle or standard before its children.

3. Permanently delete – Removes normal recovery and requires typing DELETE. Use only when you intend to remove the tracker record permanently.

What happens to the files?

Tracker deletion does not delete Google Drive files. Portal-uploaded file bytes and version metadata are retained; access to inactive files is restricted to administrators.

If restoration reports a conflict

Check whether a record with the same identifier already exists, or whether its parent is still archived. Resolve the reported conflict before trying again.

Remember: Deleting a built-in sidebar section hides it; its underlying records remain saved. Restore the section to make it available again.

Delete and recover safely

Administrator actions, with recoverable archives

Where to delete an item

Evidence: use the trash icon on its library card, then confirm.
Cycle: use the trash icon at the bottom of the cycle workspace. **Standard, criterion or review task**: open its edit form and use Delete. **Sidebar section**: right-click its name to open the menu.

Restore an accidental deletion

1. Return to the homepage and open **Archives**.
2. Locate the item by its name, type and cycle. Choose **Restore**.
3. If the parent cycle or standard was also deleted, restore the parent first. Resolve any reported duplicate or conflict before retrying.

Deleting a built-in sidebar section hides the section; its underlying records remain saved. Restoring it makes it available again.

Permanent deletion is different

Permanently delete removes an archived tracker record from normal recovery and requires typing DELETE. Do not use it for routine cleanup. Google Drive files are not deleted by tracker actions. Uploaded file bytes and version metadata are retained; access to inactive files is restricted to administrators.

Know what your backup contains

Download backup: a JSON copy of the open cycle's project data. It includes references to documents, not the uploaded files themselves.
Export criteria CSV: a criteria register, not a complete backup.
Full system backup: IT must back up the database to preserve all cycles, uploads, versions, accounts and archives.

Remember: Restore backup replaces a cycle's project data after confirmation. Download a current backup first. Keep all exports containing university information in approved private storage.

When something goes wrong

Quick checks before asking for help

Changes were not saved

Keep the form open and read its error message. The portal can merge unrelated changes made in another tab, but overlapping edits require review. Copy unsaved text before refreshing; a downloaded backup does not contain unsaved form text. Check that your session is still active, then retry.

A document will not open

For portal evidence, sign in and check that the evidence and its cycle are active. For Google Drive, request access from the document owner. Localhost links cannot be opened from a colleague's computer.

A button or owner is missing

Creation, deletion and access-management controls require an administrator role. Newly added owners appear after refreshing the workspace. A missing sidebar section may need restoring from Archives.

An upload fails

Check the file type, that the file is not empty, and the 10 MB limit. If the message reports a storage limit, contact the administrator. All retained versions count toward storage usage.

Before you finish

- Save edited forms and charts; confirm that the save completed.
- Check owners, workflow statuses and evidence statuses.
- Verify that the intended people can open the linked documents.
- Review outstanding semester checklists and the progress tracker.
- Return to the homepage and choose Sign out when finished.

Remember: Send support the page name, the action you tried and the error text. Share screenshots with confidential details hidden. Never send passwords or sign-in codes.